

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **BILINGUAL SECRETARY** Uses a knowledge of one or more foreign languages to translate business communications and research materials, and to liaise with overseas clients face-to-face or by telephone. Administration skills are also essential in this job.
- ▶ **TECHNICAL AUTHOR** Writes user manuals, technical guides, and online blogs for a wide range of industries and products. They are highly skilled at presenting very technical information in a user-friendly way.
- ▶ **VACATION REPRESENTATIVE** Looks after groups of tourists on vacation in international resorts. Proficiency in the local language and the languages of clients is highly desirable.



CAREER PATHS

Translation is a degree-level profession, but graduate degrees in translation can greatly enhance your employment opportunities. Fluency in two or more languages is a key requirement, and knowledge of a specific sector, such as business, finance, or technology, is an advantage.

TRANSLATOR Once qualified as a translator, you can take several routes. You could specialize in specific scripts. Experienced translators may move into a number of different areas.

GRADUATE To find work in this field you may need a degree in modern languages and preferably a postgraduate qualification in translation. Taking language proficiency tests is another way you can increase your credibility as a translator.



GOVERNMENT TRANSLATOR

Works for government departments, such as security and intelligence services. Governments can offer a clear and structured career path in this field.



INTERPRETER Converts the spoken word from one language to another between people who do not speak the same language. A clear, strong voice is essential.



TRANSLATION AGENCY MANAGER Sets up an independent business, and employs freelance workers to provide translation services to clients in government and the private sector.



FREELANCE TRANSLATOR

Registers with agencies or finds translation jobs using their own contacts. This option is typically for more experienced translators who are confident to work on an independent basis.